

Strikes had been one nonviolent way to stand up against unfair laws. Boycotts were another. A boycott is a refusal to buy certain items. In India, the British controlled the manufacture and sale of cloth. Gandhi urged Indians to refuse to buy the British cloth, so that the British cloth industry would make less money and profit in India.

Instead, Gandhi supported Indians making their own cloth. By making cloth at home, the Indian community would keep more money instead of paying the British. Gandhi believed that spinning and weaving would help give Indians freedom from British control.

Gandhi himself vowed to spin thread every day. He even stayed up late into the night to spin if he had to. He started wearing *khadi* (clothing made of hand-spun cloth) with sandals, and a shawl in cooler weather. To Gandhi,